



Participant information sheet (focus group)

Enhancing Opportunities for Toddlers' Wellbeing

You are being invited to take part in a focus group, part of the Erasmus+ project 'Enhancing the education and wellbeing of disadvantaged toddlers through the development of training and materials to support early years practitioners' (ToWe). The project aims at developing new approaches to Continuing Professional Development (CPD) for Early Years Practitioners to enable them to maximise on the learning opportunities of disadvantaged toddlers (18-36 months). Please take time to read the following information and discuss with others if you wish. Also please ask us any questions you may have, using the contact details below. We are a team of academic lecturers and researchers who work in the School of Education, at Kingston University London.

What is the purpose of the project?

The aim of the project is to improve the practice of early year's practitioners working with disadvantaged toddlers, in order to help them get the best start to formal education, in the hope that they will go on to maximise their potential and be active citizens in the future. During the focus group you will be asked your opinion about the CPD course and the materials designed by the ToWe team.

Why have I been invited?

You have been invited to take part because you previously agreed to be part of the Project, use the materials developed by the ToWe team in your Early Years setting and participate in CPD training and job shadowing.



~~Do~~ **Employment Application Form**

1. Completing and returning the Application Form

Please complete the Application Form and return to the Kent FA by email at jobs@kentfa.com by the closing date specified in the job advert. Applications received after this time will only be considered in exceptional circumstances.

The decision to progress your application to the next stage of the selection process will be based only on the information you provide on this form.

2. Position applied for

I have to take part?

~~It is entirely up to you to decide whether or not to take part. If you decide not to take part this will not affect any relationship you may have with the ToWe team and Kingston University. If you do take part you are free to withdraw at any time, without giving any reason and without any detriment to you.~~

What will happen if I do take part?

~~If you agree to take part in the focus group, then you will be given a copy of this information sheet to keep and be asked to sign a consent form. You will then be asked to take part in a group interview with a researcher, which will last about 60 minutes. Interviews will take place at Kingston University. The interviewer will ask your opinion about the CPD course and the materials developed by the ToWe team. You will also be asked about the ways your setting has been organized to implement ToWe activities (e.g. number of practitioners involved, timing, meetings). Interviews are usually digitally recorded so that they can be accurately transcribed. However, you can ask the interviewer to take notes rather than record your interview if you wish.~~

What are the possible benefits of taking part?

~~Participation offers the opportunity to reflect on practice issues. It is hoped that information from this study may contribute to enhance the quality of education for disadvantaged toddlers. There are no financial or other inducements to taking part.~~

What are the risks of taking part?

~~There are no anticipated risks. Some people may find talking about their experiences in group or having their views challenged in public upsetting. If this happens you can stop the interview or take a break at any time. You can also ask to speak to a member of the research team, who is an experienced practitioner in your field.~~

Will my taking part in the study be kept confidential?



Yes. We will follow ethical and legal practice and all information will be handled in confidence. Only the research team, and a transcriber who has signed a confidentiality agreement, will have access to the original data from the focus group. However, any concerns that the safety of a child or adult is at risk will need to be reported as outlined in statutory safeguarding procedures. All the information gathered will be securely stored on a password protected computer and no names or contact details will be attached to the data files.

What will happen to the results of the study?

We will write up the findings from this project in an article for a suitable journal, and may also present them at an academic conference. The findings will also form part of the results for the Intellectual Output 7 – Case Study Impact Report of ToWe, with the strategies you develop forming support and guidance for Early Years Practitioners in Intellectual Outputs 3 – Toddlers' Wellbeing, 4 – Toddlers' Voice and Expressions, 5 – Toddlers' Meal Times and 6 – Toddlers' Additional Language(s). You will not be identified in any way.

Who has reviewed this research?

In order to protect your safety, rights, and dignity, the study has been looked at by the Faculty Research Ethics Committee, an independent group of people within the Faculty of Health, Education and Social Care. The committee has given a favourable opinion.

What if I have any questions or want to complain?

If you have any questions or problems, please contact any member of the research team, using the details provided below. If you are not satisfied with the response you get from the research team and wish to make a complaint, please contact the Dean of Faculty, Andy Kent, whose details are also provided below.

Contact Details:

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3. Personal Details

<u>First Name(s)</u>	
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<u>Last Name</u>	<u>Mr/Ms or preferred title</u>	
<u>Postal address</u>		
<u>Post Code</u>		
<u>Email Address</u>		
<u>What is your preferred contact method? (phone, email, text other)</u>		
<u>What is the best phone number to contact you on?</u>		
<u>What is the most convenient time of day to contact you by phone?</u>		
<u>Are you eligible to work in the UK?</u>		
<u>Do you hold a full driving licence?</u>		
<u>If you have any requirements in respect of the recruitment or interview process, please provide details.</u>		
<u>Due to the nature of this role the successful candidate will be required to undertake a Disclosure and Barring Service (DBS) check.</u> <u>Do you have any convictions, cautions or reprimands or final warnings that are not "protected" as defined by the Rehabilitation of Offenders Act</u>	Yasmine Mukadam <i>School of Education Faculty of Health, Social Care and Education Room KH EBLG0013, School of Education, Kingston Hill Campus, Kingston Hill, Kingston-upon-Thames KT2 7LB</i>	Andy Kent Dean, Faculty of Health, Social Care and Education <i>St George's, University of London 2nd Floor Grosvenor Wing St George's Hospital Cranmer Terrace London SW17 0RE</i>



<u>1974 (Exceptions) Order 1975</u> <u>(as amended in 2013)?</u> Helen Sutherland <i>School of Education</i> <i>Faculty of Health, Social</i> <i>Care and Education</i> <i>Room KH EBLG0015,</i> <i>School of Education,</i> <i>Kingston Hill Campus,</i> <i>Kingston Hill</i> <i>Kingston-upon-Thames KT2</i> <i>7LB</i> <i>Tel: +44 (0)208 417 5394</i> <i><u>H.Sutherland@kingston.ac.uk</u></i>	<i>Tel: +44 (0)208 417 5286</i> <i><u>Y.Mukadam@kingston.ac.uk</u></i>	<i>Tel: +44 (0)20 8725 2247</i> <i><u>A.Kent@sgul.kingston.ac.uk</u></i>
<u>Do you have any offences which</u> <u>are currently unspent under the</u> <u>Rehabilitation of Offenders Act</u> <u>1974 (You do not need to</u> <u>declare anything that is deemed</u> <u>'spent')?</u>		

Start this section on a separate page.



WRITTEN CONSENT TO PARTICIPATE IN A RESEARCH STUDY

Office Use Only
Applicant Number
Statement by
Participant

- ☐ I confirm that I have read and understood the information sheet/letter of invitation for this study. I have been informed of the purpose, risks, and benefits of taking part.
- ☐ I agree to be interviewed.
- ☐ I agree for the interview to be recorded.

Enhancing Opportunities for Toddlers Wellbeing

- ☐ I understand what my involvement will entail and any questions have been answered to my satisfaction.
- ☐ I understand that my participation in the focus group is entirely voluntary, and that I can withdraw at any time without prejudice.
- ☐ I understand that should any disclosure made during the interview what may be considered as potentially harmful to a child or adults then the researcher will follow safeguarding procedures as outlined in statutory guidance.
- ☐ I agree that research data gathered for the study may contribute to papers for presentation at conferences or academic journals, provided that I cannot be identified as a subject.
- ☐ Contact information has been provided should I (a) wish to seek further information from the investigator at any time for purposes of clarification (b) wish to make a complaint.

Participant's name _____

Participant's Signature _____

Date _____

4. Employment and Volunteering History

Starting with your present or most recent job or voluntary position, please complete the table below.

<u>Start date</u>	<u>End date</u>	<u>Employer/Organisation Name & Address</u>	<u>Job/Role Title</u>	<u>Brief Description of Duties</u>



Please insert additional rows in the table above if required.

5. Qualifications

Please provide details of your qualifications achieved in the table below. (Please note that you may be asked to provide evidence of any qualifications achieved which are directly relevant to this role).

For GCSEs or equivalent there is no need to include each subject on a separate line (see example below).

<u>Dates</u>	<u>Qualification and Subject</u>	<u>Grade achieved</u>	<u>School/College/University/Training Provider Name</u>
<u>1991</u>	<u>6 GCSEs including Maths and English</u>	<u>4 x A's and 2 x B's</u>	<u>High School Name</u>



Please insert additional rows in the table above if required

6. Training courses, Registrations or Memberships.

Please give details of any training courses you have attended or professional registrations you hold not covered above (e.g. First Aid).

<u>Training course/registration/membership</u>	<u>Training provider/awarding body/organisation</u>	<u>Date attended/achieved</u>

7. Explain how you meet the requirements outlined in the job description.

Referring to the **Job Purpose(s)** and **Responsibilities** sections of the job description, provide examples from your experience at work, as a volunteer or in education which demonstrate that you have the capability to succeed in this job. (You can use bullet points in this section if you wish.)



8. Explain how your skills, knowledge and experience match the requirements outlined in the person specification?

Referring to the **Person Specification** section of the job description provide examples which demonstrate that you have the skills, knowledge and experience which are relevant to this job. (You can use bullet points in this section if you wish.)

9. How do you demonstrate the values of Kent FA?

The way we work at Kent FA is built on the values outlined in the job description. Please provide examples of how you have demonstrated these values in your work or everyday life?



10. Accessibility

Kent FA is committed to ensuring that all applicants can access the application and selection process for this role. Please detail in the box below any adjustments you require to be made to the selection process (including interviews) should your application be progressed to the next stage.

11. References



Any offer of a role will be subject to receipt of 2 satisfactory references. Please provide the details of 2 referees who have agreed to provide a reference for you. Your first referee must be your current or most recent employer.

Your second referee should be a different employer, representative of an organisation in which you volunteer or have volunteered or a representative of an educational establishment.

Personal references should only be given where there is no previous employer, voluntary organisation or educational establishment to which reference can be made.

	<u>First Referee</u>	<u>Second Referee</u>
<u>Name</u>		
<u>Job Title</u>		
<u>Email address</u>		
<u>Telephone</u>		
<u>Postal address</u>		
<u>Relationship to you</u>		
<u>Do you give permission for us to request a reference if you offered a position? (yes/no)</u>		

12. Declaration

I give my consent to the storage of personal data contained within this form for the purposes only of this application process.

I can confirm and declare that the information provided on the form, to the best of my knowledge is complete, accurate and not misleading.

<u>Signature</u>	
<u>Date</u>	